

Reality Accounting Ledger

Status: OWNER-STEERED / ADDITIVE.

This document does not replace `the-idea.md`, define an epic, or claim that the system already satisfies the realities described here. It is an accounting surface for desired realities that exceed the current implementation. Each entry names a target state, separates it from present evidence, and defines what would make it more real.

Purpose

This ledger exists to prevent high-level owner intent from living only in conversation.

Some desired realities are too large, early, or cross-cutting to enter the repo directly as epics, proposals, or done-lines. They need a holding form that preserves the target without confusing it for current fact.

This ledger is that form.

It accounts for each desired reality by separating:

```
desired reality
current reality
partial reality
unrealized delta
supporting evidence
probe candidates
next admissible move
risk if misclaimed
```

The goal is not to make speculative language official.

The goal is to make speculative direction accountable.

Governing rule

Desired reality may create pressure, but it may not count as current reality.

A desired reality can steer inquiry, shape probes, reveal missing mechanisms, or motivate a proposal.

It cannot be treated as true until there is evidence.

It cannot authorize work by itself.

It cannot bypass gates.

It cannot become doctrine by sounding coherent.

Every entry must preserve the boundary between:

```
witnessed
inferred
proposed
confirmed
implemented
external reality
local field state
```

If that boundary is unclear, the entry is not ready to guide work.

Relation to `the-idea.md`

`the-idea.md` explains the project to a cold reader.

This ledger does not repeat that job.

`the-idea.md` answers:

```
What is this project for?
Why does it matter?
How does the engine work in plain terms?
What use cases does it enable?
```

This ledger answers:

```
What desired realities is the owner carrying that are not fully real yet?
Which parts are already supported by files?
Which parts are only partial?
Which mechanisms are missing?
Which probes would let the system measure progress?
What would be dangerous to claim too early?
```

So this document is additive, not duplicative.

It is not the public explanation.

It is the accounting layer beneath future explanations.

Current upper target

The current upper target is:

A digital, AI-native inferred reality with a felt field.

More formally:

An owner-steered ambient consequence field where AI work is governed by witnessed consequences, derived primaries, synthetic field-forces, and accountable crossings.

This target does not claim that the system already has this reality.

It names the direction the system is being accounted toward.

Target Reality 001 — AI-native inferred reality

Desired reality

The system should become a bounded inferred reality for AI work.

That means it should not begin from a fixed taxonomy and force work to fit it.

It should begin from consequence witnessing:

```
what happened?  
what changed?  
what caused the change?  
what did the change touch?  
what became possible afterward?  
what became unsafe afterward?  
what pressure moved?  
what authority was used or missing?  
what trace proves this happened?
```

From those traces, the system should derive its own useful categories, primaries, operators, and field-forces.

The model comes after consequence.

Current reality

The repo already contains several ingredients of this direction:

```
files as durable workplace  
append-only record as memory  
folds as re-derived state  
gates as checkpoints  
pens as sanctioned write paths  
owner decisions as authority  
proposals as pre-epic captured shapes  
outcomes as desired realities expressed through probes
```

These pieces support the target, but they do not yet equal the target.

Partial reality

The system can preserve some traces, fold some state, gate some work, and express some desired realities as probes.

It can also describe the need to derive primaries from the body of work instead of importing fixed categories.

But that derivation is not yet a complete installed mechanism.

Unrealized delta

The system does not yet have a general primitive for consequence witnessing.

It does not yet have a stable grammar for model-free-first observation.

It does not yet derive local primaries from repeated consequence traces.

It does not yet distinguish every unit cleanly across:

```
witnessed  
inferred  
proposed  
confirmed  
implemented
```

Accounting

Supporting files and areas:

```
docs/culture/the-idea.md
accounting-attributing-organ.proposal.md
outcome-pressure-fold.proposal.md
session-gateway.proposal.md
gateway-policy-spine.proposal.md
structured-communication-channel.proposal.md
```

Probe candidates

P1 – Given 10 recorded work events, the system can account for what changed, what caused it, and what downstream pressure moved.

P2 – The system can distinguish witnessed, inferred, proposed, confirmed, and implemented states in a way that prevents inference from being treated as fact.

P3 – The system can derive at least one local primary from repeated consequence traces rather than from a hand-authored taxonomy.

Next admissible move

Define a minimum consequence-witness record:

```
actor
surface
gesture/action
object
before-state
after-state
observed consequence
source/evidence
confidence
reversibility
authority
attribution
next pressure
```

Risk if misclaimed

If this target is claimed too early, the system begins treating inference as reality.

That is the failure mode.

An inferred reality must remain accountable to witnessed traces, or it becomes an ungoverned story.

Target Reality 002 — Felt field

Desired reality

The system should not only display facts.

It should represent the state of work as a felt field: a structured set of force-like pressures that make current reality legible.

A session should be able to inherit signals such as:

```
hot
blocked
stale
risky
over capacity
ready
orphaned
converging
exploratory
owner-needed
```

The owner should not need to inspect every file, branch, issue, and proposal to understand the shape of the work.

The field should compress current reality into computable forces.

Candidate field-forces:

```
pressure:
  gap between current reality and desired reality

gravity:
  high-consequence work attracts attention

friction:
  uncertainty, missing authority, or risk slows motion

heat:
```

volatility, exploration, too many live branches, unsettled language

cooling:

consolidation, review, landing, pruning

tension:

contradiction or mismatch between claims, files, and reality

momentum:

repeated successful routes become easier to reuse

inertia:

stale unlanded work resists movement

freshness:

old folds decay and demand re-checking

capacity:

each surface can only hold so much pressure

risk:

blast radius multiplied by uncertainty and irreversibility

These names are not decorative metaphors. Each must eventually become a computable fold or be rejected.

Current reality

The project already has pressure, gaps, outcomes, probes, reports, owner asks, and summon surfaces.

These partially express felt state.

Partial reality

The system can sometimes surface a top gap or next pressure point.

It cannot yet compute a multi-force state of the field.

It cannot yet produce a standard payload such as:

pressure: high
friction: medium
heat: high
freshness: stale

```
owner-load: over cap
top allowed discharge: ask owner to bless probe P3
```

Unrealized delta

There is no admitted field-force register.

There are no force folds.

There is no shared rule for what a force may surface, route, or trigger.

There is no structural guarantee that a force cannot authorize action by itself.

Accounting

Supporting files and areas:

```
outcome-pressure-fold.proposal.md
strategy-metabolism.md
session-gateway.proposal.md
gated-pubsub-brokerage.proposal.md
```

Probe candidates

P1 – At session wake, the system can surface at least 3 computed field-forces with supporting evidence.

P2 – Each force has a definition, input set, fold/check, failure mode, and permitted response path.

P3 – No field-force can authorize action directly; it can only surface pressure or route to a gateway.

Next admissible move

Create a field-force register:

```
field-forces.md
```

Each force entry should include:


```
definition
inputs
computed fold or check
what it makes visible
what it may route
what it must never authorize
failure mode
```

Risk if misclaimed

If the felt field is claimed before it is computable, the system will confuse evocative language with operational state.

That would weaken the project.

A force is admitted only when it can be checked.

Target Reality 003 — Liveness instead of scheduling

Desired reality

The system should not be scheduler-native.

A scheduler-native system says:

```
time arrives → run job
```

The desired reality is:

```
field is on
signals arrive
folds re-derive pressure
thresholds trip
gateways permit or refuse crossings
actuators discharge allowed motion
receipts alter the next fold
```

Scheduling may remain as one pulse source.

It should not be the root model.

The root model is liveness: the field is available to witness change, re-derive state, and surface pressure.

Current reality

The repo already has hooks, folds, reports, summons, gaps, and proposed gateway behavior.

It already moves toward inherited pressure at session wake.

Partial reality

There are pulses and event-like behaviors, but no single ambient-loop doctrine.

The project can describe parts of liveness, but it does not yet have a clean formal layer for it.

Unrealized delta

There is no dedicated document that explains moment-to-moment liveness without treating scheduling as the root.

There is no standard pulse grammar:

```
time pulse
event pulse
owner-arrival pulse
repo-change pulse
external-signal pulse
threshold-crossing pulse
manual wake pulse
```

There is no formal law that a stream may witness and route but not command.

Accounting

Supporting files and areas:

```
docs/culture/the-idea.md
session-gateway.proposal.md
gated-pubsub-brokerage.proposal.md
outcome-pressure-fold.proposal.md
```

Probe candidates

P1 – The repo contains a cold-readable ambient-loop document.

P2 – Pulse types are defined and separated from authorization.

P3 – A pulse can cause sensing, folding, and routing, but cannot itself authorize consequential action.

Next admissible move

Write:

the-ambient-loop.md

Minimum law:

Streams witness.
Folds derive.
Thresholds surface pressure.
Gateways decide crossings.
Actuators discharge permitted motion.
Records preserve consequence.
The owner steers authority.

Risk if misclaimed

If liveness is misclaimed, a long-running process may become a hidden authority.

The stream must not become the scheduler-god.

It is a carrier of availability, not a source of permission.

Target Reality 004 — Reusable operators, not fixed workflows

Desired reality

The system should not only run predesigned workflows.

It should learn reusable operators: repeated, attributed routes that reliably change the field inside accepted consequence boundaries.

A fixed workflow says:

do these steps in this order

A learned operator says:

given this pressure, this authority, this surface, and this reversibility class,
this route has repeatedly produced acceptable consequences

Candidate operators:

turn owner intent into probes
separate desired reality from current reality
surface a decision without flooding the owner
route a raw idea into proposal form
request independent review
quarantine unsafe motion
promote a snapshot
prune stale possibility
derive a local primary from a corpus

Current reality

The project already has repeated routes and instruments:

ask
recommend
gate
fold
land
reflect
summon
review
confirm

Some of these are close to reusable operators.

Partial reality

The routes exist, but they are not yet classified as operators.

The system does not yet measure whether a route reliably creates acceptable consequences.

Unrealized delta

There is no operator register.

There is no distinction between:

```
tool  
workflow  
operator  
reflex  
surface  
gateway  
habit
```

There is no test for whether an operator is learned rather than merely described.

Accounting

Supporting files and areas:

```
structured-communication-channel.proposal.md  
gateway-policy-spine.proposal.md  
session-gateway.proposal.md  
strategy-metabolism.md  
docs/culture/the-idea.md
```

Probe candidates

P1 – The repo can name 10 repeated routes and classify each as tool, workflow, operator, reflex, surface, gateway, or habit.

P2 – At least 3 operators have evidence of repeated successful use.

P3 – Each admitted operator has an accepted consequence envelope.

Next admissible move

Create:

```
operator-register.md
```

Definition:

An operator is a repeated, attributed route that reliably changes the field within an accepted consequence envelope.

Risk if misclaimed

If operators are misclaimed, the system will rename workflows as learning.

That weakens the distinction.

A route becomes an operator only when repeated consequence supports it.

Entry template

Each entry in this ledger should use the same accounting shape:

```
## Target Reality NNN – [short name]

### Desired reality
What state the owner is trying to make real.

### Why it matters
Why this changes the class of the system.

### Current reality
What exists today in files, code, tests, logs, receipts, docs, or admitted
records.

### Partial reality
What exists as seed, proposal, analogy, one-off mechanism, local pattern, or
unresolved composition.

### Unrealized delta
What is missing.

### Accounting
Which files, probes, receipts, folds, or records support the inventory.

### Probe candidates
Checkable desired-reality statements.

### Next admissible move
The smallest useful formal move.

### Risk if misclaimed
What breaks if this desired reality is treated as current fact too early.
```

Standing law

Desired realities enter as pressure, not truth.

They become truth only through evidence.

They become work only through admitted routes.

They become authority only through governance.

They become system behavior only through implementation.

They become experience only when their traces remain comparable.